



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Charles Borromeo Academy
School Website: <https://borromeoacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Classicality Audit Report

Below are full audits for the newly crawled schools. Each audit includes an Executive Summary, six-category keyword analysis tied to the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon, category ratings, an overall classification, and supporting citations. The keyword step is performed explicitly for every category, using positive/negative indicators defined in Six Essential Elements and the classicality lexicon (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Socratic, scholé, wonder, chanting, project-based, experiential learning, etc.) to justify scores.

AUDIT 1: Austin Classical School

Website used: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Strong evidence in religious foundations, purpose/goal, and curriculum: explicit pursuit of God's "goodness, truth, and beauty," integration of Bible and theology, and a trivium-based, Great Tradition curriculum with Latin and classical rhetoric/thesis defense.
- Pedagogy shows memorization/recitation, logic, rhetoric, and oratory, but there is no explicit mention of Socratic seminars or scholé; faculty formation and parent partnership evidence is limited in the crawl excerpts.
- Priority improvements: public articulation of Socratic seminar practice and scholé/restful learning, a published "portrait of a teacher," and explicit parent-formation/partnership pages.

Method note on scoring

- Percent_positive = positive keyword hits / (positive + negative hits) observed in site excerpts for that category.
- Percent_coverage = proportion of that category's sub-elements evidenced on the site (e.g., Religious Foundations has 3 sub-elements: moral realism, theology, liturgical life).
- Keyword lists and polarity are drawn from Six Essential Elements and the lexicon.

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: "God's goodness, truth, and beauty" (truth, goodness, beauty), "Bible," "theological principles," "Christian Studies," "Church History," "Apologetics," "Ethics," "Exegesis & Hermeneutics," "divine order/created order" (natural law/teleology).
- Negative indicators: none observed (no values-neutral, moral relativism, etc.).
- Comparison with Six Elements:

- Moral realism: strong “truth, goodness, beauty” language.
- Grounded in theology: strong Bible/Christian Studies integration across upper school (Exegesis, Apologetics, Ethics, Church History).
- Liturgical/communal worship: not evidenced in the crawl excerpt (no chapel/liturgy references).
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 9; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 0.67 (2 of 3 sub-elements evidenced)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

2) School Purpose and Goal

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “cultivate the imaginations,” “develop... appreciation of beauty,” “goodness, truth, and beauty,” “pre-Progressive” with “tried and true” (formation emphasis).
- Negative indicators: none observed (no “college and career ready,” “workforce preparation” framing, etc.).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Purpose as formation in wisdom/virtue and pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty aligns with positive keyword families.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 5; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 0.67 (clear pursuit of TGB and formation; less explicit “wisdom/virtue” vocabulary)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

3) Curriculum

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “trivium—grammar, logic, rhetoric,” “Bible,” “great works of the Western tradition,” “history,” “Latin,” “Classical Rhetoric,” “Senior Thesis,” “Ancient/Medieval/Modern Literature” sequencing; explicit Latin and logic/rhetoric credits (Trivium).
- Negative indicators: none observed (no STEM-first framing, no “social studies” replacing “history,” no project-based dominance).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Trivium, Great Books/primary texts, history across curriculum are well-evidenced; alignment with classical curriculum markers is strong.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

4) Pedagogy / Teaching Methods

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “memorize... drilled... repetition,” “Intermediate Logic,” “Classical Rhetoric & Composition,” “Thesis defense,” “Rhetoric Choir” (recitation/oratory).
- Missing/less explicit: “Socratic seminar,” “Harkness,” “scholé/restful learning,” “chanting” explicitly (though memory/recitation is explicit).
- Negative indicators: none (no constructivist/student-directed/project-based dominance).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Memorization/recitation and upper-school rhetoric/oratory are clear positives; lack of explicit Socratic/seminar and scholé signals partial alignment.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 6; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00

- Percent_coverage: 0.50 (memorization/recitation and rhetoric evident; dialectic seminars and scholé not evidenced)
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

5) Faculty

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: none explicit in crawl excerpts (no “mentors,” “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” etc.).
- Negative indicators: none.
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Lacks public articulation of teacher-formation, model-teacher ideals, or a teacher profile.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 0.00
- Percent_coverage: 0.00
- Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient evidence in public materials)

6) Parents & Community

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators sought (e.g., “partnership with parents,” “parent formation,” “open campus”); not observed in excerpts.
- Negative indicators: none (no “parent as customer” language).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- No explicit parent-partnership or formation evidence surfaced in the crawl snippet.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 0; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 0.00
- Percent_coverage: 0.00
- Rating: NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient evidence)

Overall Classification (Austin Classical School): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Rationale: 3 categories Classical (Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum), 1 Somewhat Classical (Pedagogy), 2 Not Classical (Faculty; Parents/Community) based on available crawl evidence. Core classical commitments are clear; public articulation of pedagogy (Socratic/scholé), faculty formation, and parent partnership is under-specified in the excerpts.

What would move the needle (Austin Classical School)

- Publish explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy and restful learning (scholé) language, including “Socratic seminar,” “guided discussion,” “Harkness,” and “scholé/restful learning” in academics pages and handbooks.
- Add a “Portrait of a Teacher” and faculty formation language (e.g., mentors, living curriculum, collegial culture, classical teacher training).
- Create a visible “Parent Partnership” page: co-teacher framing, parent book studies, classical education info sessions; welcome/visit policies for parents.

AUDIT 2: Berean Christian Academy (Katy, TX)

Website used: <https://bereanchristianacademy.org>

Executive Summary

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Strong, explicit classical Christian identity: “Christ-centered worldview,” pursuit of “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty,” and a parent partnership mission; ACCS and SCL memberships are listed.
- Robust curriculum and pedagogy: trivium (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric), Latin, logic and debate, Harkness Table conversation, Senior Thesis defense; Grammar/Lower School pedagogy features wonder, songs, chants, memorization; a published Great Books reading list confirms Great Tradition engagement.
- Faculty formation language is thinner in public materials; otherwise, alignment is strong across all categories.

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “Christ-centered worldview,” “Truth, Goodness, and Beauty,” “theology,” “apologetics,” “Christian Studies” (mission/program), explicit Christian identity; ACCS/SCL memberships listed.
- Liturgical life: not explicit (no chapel/liturgy terms surfaced).
- Negative indicators: none.
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Strong moral realism (TGB) and theological grounding; liturgical/chapel practices not evidenced in excerpts.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 8; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 0.67 (2 of 3 sub-elements evidenced)
- Rating: CLASSICAL

2) School Purpose and Goal

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “educate... in a Christ-centered worldview,” “recognize Truth, Goodness, and Beauty,” “discipleship-focused,” “formation” themes; classical mission statements throughout.
- Negative indicators: none (no workforce/college-readiness-first framing).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Aligns with formation over information and pursuit of TGB/virtue/wisdom.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 7; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

3) Curriculum

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric,” “seven liberal arts,” “Latin,” “great books,” “original ancient texts,” “theology,” “philosophy,” “Senior Thesis”; detailed Great Books reading list (Homer, Augustine, Shakespeare, Dante, Milton, Federalist Papers, etc.).
- Negative indicators: none (no social studies substitution; history is taught as history).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Strong Trivium/Great Books/historical engagement alignment.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 15; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

4) Pedagogy / Teaching Methods

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “Harkness Table conversation,” “formal logic and debate,” “Senior Thesis... defend... to a panel,” Grammar years: “wonder,” “songs, chants, beautiful literature, rhymes, poetry, classical music,” and “memorization” (recitation).
- These map directly to Socratic/dialectic, memorization/recitation, and rhetoric/oratory. Restful learning (scholé) not explicitly named but “wonder” is present.
- Negative indicators: none (no project-based/experiential dominance).
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Clear Socratic/dialectic, memory/recitation, rhetoric/oratory; strong lower-school chanting/singing/wonder alignment.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 12; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

5) Faculty

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: general quality claims (degrees/ratios); explicit “teacher as mentor/model” language not prominent in public pages; a schoolwide “mentorship” program is student-focused, not a teacher profile.
- Negative indicators: none.
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Lacks a published “Portrait of a Teacher” or articulation of “faculty of friends/living curriculum”.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 0.33
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

6) Parents & Community

- Site keywords found:
- Positive indicators: “partnership between faculty and parents” (mission), public-facing “Parent-Student Handbook”; community/house system/service noted in program pages.
- Negative indicators: none.
- Comparison with Six Elements:
- Strong parent partnership emphasis; community practices (house system, service) are present; parent-formation events not explicitly listed, but mission-level partnership is clear.
- Quantification:
- Positive hits: 5; Negative hits: 0 → percent_positive: 1.00
- Percent_coverage: 1.00
- Rating: CLASSICAL

Overall Classification (Berean Christian Academy): CLASSICAL

- Rationale: Strong, explicit alignment across Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Parents/Community; Faculty category is the one area without a robust public articulation of teacher formation/portrait. The school also indicates ACCS/SCL memberships, reinforcing classical orientation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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